

Staging Checklist for a *Hamilton* Group Performance

1. Use of Space

- How will you use the stage area?
- Will characters stay still or move around frequently?
- Which characters should be centre stage at important moments?
- How can levels (standing, sitting, kneeling, platforms) show power or status?

2. Movement and Choreography

- What kind of movement fits the mood of the song?
- Will movements be sharp, chaotic, controlled, military, graceful, etc.?
- How can ensemble members support the storytelling through movement?
- Are there repeated gestures or motifs you could use?

3. Character Positioning

- Who stands closest together?
- Who is isolated?
- How can positioning show relationships, conflict, or alliances?
- How does the stage picture change during emotional moments?

4. Facial Expressions and Body Language

- What emotions should characters communicate physically?
- How can posture reveal confidence, fear, anger, ambition, or sadness?
- What small reactions can background performers include?

5. Props

- Which simple props could help tell the story?
- How can props symbolize ideas like war, power, writing, or legacy?
- Can props be used creatively rather than realistically?

6. Costume Choices

- Will costumes be historically accurate, modernised, or symbolic?

- How can colours represent characters or emotions?
- What costume details help the audience quickly understand each role?

7. Lighting Ideas

- What lighting would match the mood of the song?
- When should lighting become brighter, darker, warmer, colder, or more dramatic?
- Could spotlights highlight important characters or moments?

8. Music and Rhythm

- How should movement connect to the beat or lyrics?
- Are there moments where silence or stillness could be powerful?
- How can pacing build tension or excitement?

9. Ensemble Work

- How does the ensemble contribute to the atmosphere?
- Can ensemble members become symbolic figures (crowds, soldiers, memories, pressure, society)?
- How can background performers remain engaged even when not speaking?

10. Symbolism

- Are there objects, movements, or stage pictures that could symbolize bigger ideas?
- How can staging reflect themes like ambition, legacy, revolution, love, or power?

11. Transitions

- How will actors move between scenes or moments smoothly?
- Can transitions happen in character?
- How can freezes, slow motion, or tableaux be used effectively?

12. Audience Impact

- What emotion should the audience feel at the end?
- Which moment should be the most memorable visually?
- How can you make key lyrics stand out through staging?